

tmux Reference

prefix `Ctrl-Space` · sessionizer · resurrect · popups

Prefix = `Ctrl-Space` · config: `~/configs/tmux/tmux.conf` Everything below marked *prefix* means: `Ctrl-Space` , release, then the key.

Projects & Sessions

KEY	ACTION
prefix <code>Ctrl-f</code>	Sessionizer — fuzzy-pick any project dir, create-or-switch to its session
prefix <code>Ctrl-j</code>	Fuzzy-switch among <i>running</i> sessions only
prefix <code>s</code>	Session tree (visual browser, built-in)
prefix <code>L</code>	Toggle to last session — great for A ↔ B ping-pong
prefix <code>\$</code>	Rename session
prefix <code>d</code>	Detach (session keeps running)
prefix <code>(</code> / <code>)</code>	Previous / next session

`tmux-sessionizer` also works from any shell prompt.

Persistence (resurrect + continuum)

KEY	ACTION
prefix <code>Ctrl-s</code>	Save all sessions to disk (layouts, cwds, programs)
prefix <code>Ctrl-r</code>	Restore saved sessions
—	continuum autosaves every 15 min and auto-restores when tmux starts, so reboots are survivable with zero keystrokes

Popups

KEY	ACTION
prefix <code>g</code>	Lazygit over the current pane's repo — close and nothing has moved
prefix <code>Ctrl-t</code>	Scratch terminal (same session every time; same key inside dismisses)
prefix <code>D</code>	TODO.md for this project (or personal todo)

Scrollback superpowers

KEY	ACTION
prefix <code>Tab</code>	extrakto — fzf-pick any token on screen (path, hash, URL, error) and insert it at your prompt
prefix <code>u</code>	fzf-url — pick any URL in scrollback, open in browser
prefix <code>I</code>	Enter copy mode (vi keys)
<code>v</code> / <code>y</code> (copy mode)	Begin selection / yank to system clipboard
mouse drag	Copies on release (tmux-yank)
prefix <code>P</code>	Paste tmux buffer

Panes

KEY	ACTION
<code>Ctrl-h/j/k/l</code>	Move between panes and nvim splits — no prefix (smart-splits)
<code>Alt-h</code> / <code>Alt-l</code>	Resize horizontally — no prefix, crosses nvim boundary too
<code>Alt-r</code> / <code>Alt-d</code>	Resize vertically — no prefix
prefix <code>%</code> / <code>"</code>	Split right / below (opens in current directory)
prefix <code>h/j/k/l</code>	Move between panes (prefixed variant)
prefix <code>z</code>	Zoom pane fullscreen (toggle)
prefix <code>x</code>	Kill pane (confirms)
prefix <code>!</code>	Break pane out into its own window
prefix <code>{</code> / <code>}</code>	Swap pane left / right
prefix <code>q</code>	Show pane numbers (press number to jump)
prefix <code>Space</code>	Cycle layouts

Windows

KEY	ACTION
prefix <code>c</code>	New window (in current directory)
prefix <code>n</code> / <code>p</code>	Next / previous window
prefix <code>1</code> — <code>9</code>	Jump to window by number (numbering starts at 1)
prefix <code>w</code>	Window picker
prefix <code>,</code>	Rename window (auto-names to its directory otherwise)
prefix <code>&</code>	Kill window (confirms)
prefix <code>.</code>	Move window to another index

Admin

KEY	ACTION
prefix <code>r</code>	Reload tmux.conf
prefix <code>I</code>	TPM: install new plugins
prefix <code>U</code>	TPM: update plugins
prefix <code>t</code>	Clock, if you ever need to feel calm
prefix <code>?</code>	List every binding tmux knows

Behavior worth remembering (set in conf, no keys)

- **Killing a session drops you into the next one** instead of detaching (`detach-on-destroy off`) — kill finished projects fearlessly.
- **Windows auto-rename to their directory** — `api` | `web` | `configs` , not `zsh` | `zsh` | `zsh` .
- Splits and new windows **open in the directory you're in**, not `$HOME` .
- Escape time is 10ms, so nvim mode-switching never lags.
- iTerm tab title shows `session` · `window` .